Ankur Abhiyan

As the state continues to develop its green cover, Chief Minister Shri Chouhan started involving the society and the people in mega government campaigns and today this initiative has reached its peak. On the initiative of the Chief Minister, a state-wide **"Ankur Abhiyan"** was launched to ensure public participation in the protection and conservation of the environment. Lakhs of people in the state have planted a large number of saplings by registering online and have also taken up the responsibility of protecting the saplings. A target of planting 10 lakh 19 thousand saplings has been set in the program. This campaign is going on continuously with public participation.

The Chief Minister's initiative is proof that miraculous results can be obtained if a positive goal is pursued in the right direction. The credit for creating a successful public participation model of various works in the country goes to Madhya Pradesh, the consciousness of its citizens, and the efficient leadership of Chief Minister Shri Shivraj Singh. The growth in the green canopy is also a result of people's association with the CM in the tree plantation campaign and the success in this field is an example for other states as well.

Today Madhya Pradesh has a 94689 sq. km forest area, which is the highest forest area compared to other states. It is 30.72 percent of the state's area and 12.30 percent of the total forest area of the country. On the one hand, the forests of Madhya Pradesh abound in trees that produce precious timber like teak, sal as well as bamboo, and on the other hand, they are well-known for the production of minor forest produce like Tendu Patta, Mahua, Chironji, Harra, Bahera, and Amla. Madhya Pradesh is also a leading state in the conservation of biodiversity and wildlife. Madhya Pradesh holds the status of Tiger State. The state has the highest number of 526 tigers in the country. Besides, there are 3421 leopards, 2000 rare gharials, 9447 vultures, and 772 wolves in the state.

Along with this, the life-nurturing rivers flowing in Madhya Pradesh are the source of water supply not only for Madhya Pradesh but also for neighboring states in all four directions. Narmada, Chambal, Sindh, Betwa, Ken, Son, Wainganga, and Tapti are the major rivers that originate in Madhya Pradesh. That is why Madhya Pradesh is also called the heart state of the country. The source of water in the rivers of Madhya Pradesh is not a glacier like the Himalayas, but the forest cover is located around the catchments. Therefore, the forest cover of the state is important not only for the development and prosperity of Madhya Pradesh but also for the entire country.



Going Green with the hard work of the Forest Department and Forest Village Committees

One-third of the villages in Madhya Pradesh are located in or around forest areas. The livelihood and culture of the communities living around the forests are based on the forest itself, that is, forests play an important role in every aspect of the life of these communities. This work of increasing the forest cover of Madhya Pradesh has happened with the collaboration of all. The Forest Department of Madhya Pradesh also paid special attention to the care of forests with the support of village forest committees by undertaking micro-planning continuously. The Forest Department has succeeded in restoring the denuded forest areas of the state by involving the local communities in the management of the forest. Badi Naldi Village Forest Committee of the Jhabua district was given the responsibility of restoring the vacant forest area of 192 hectares about 15 years ago. With the tireless efforts of the Village Forest Committees and the residents, the splendor of this area has been restored. With the restoration of the forest cover, now the means of livelihood of the forest dwellers have also started increasing, and along with it, a proper solution has been found to deal with the challenges of climate change.

Madhya Pradesh is the first state to give the rights of forest land to forest dwellers

On 22 April 2022, in a program held in Bhopal under the chief honorable presence of the Home Minister Shri Amit Shah, the Chief Minister also launched the work of converting 827 forest villages of 26 districts into **'Rajasv Gram'** (revenue villages) while also distributing dividend amounts to the Tendu Patta collectors. On this occasion, Shri Shah, while hailing the efforts of the Chief Minister Shri Shivraj Singh Chouhan and the Madhya Pradesh government, also said that the state has done works that have brought about momentous changes. The steps taken by Madhya Pradesh in the direction of the development of tribal communities and forests are exemplary. This initiative of Madhya Pradesh is inspiring and exemplary for all.

On this occasion, the Chief Minister of the state Shri Shivraj Singh Chouhan said that the water, land, and forests belong to the forest dwellers. With the conversion of forest villages into revenue villages, the life of the forest dwellers will improve and they will get better amenities. The forest dwellers will cooperate in the development of forests by getting a share of the income earned from the forests and the forest department will play the role of a collaborator in this work.

Achievements of Forest Committees

- **More than 4 lakh hectare forest area of 1152 villages converted from degraded forest to dense forest**
- **Micro plan approved for participatory forest management of 2612 forest committees, forest restoration work in progress in 6.22 lakh hectares of degraded forest area**
- **This year the Rs. 55 crore dividend of wood and bamboo has been paid to the committees.**

Steps that were taken for wildlife management

- **Business of Rs 460 crore per year from tourism in 11 national parks and 24 sanctuaries of the state**
- **26 new entrance gates opened and 2000 permanent jobs were created under 'buffer me safar' (tourism in buffer areas of national parks)**
- **The committees have right over one-third of the fee collected in national parks and sanctuaries and full right over the income from ecotourism in the buffer zones**